Indiana University Health

Reid, Stephen W

DOB: 10/13/1944
MRN: 73394375
Visit Date: 05/16/2025

Discharge Instructions

We would like to thank you for allowing us to assist you with your healthcare needs. The following includes patient education materials and information regarding your injury/illness.

Your ED Provider

Time Seen:
Chaney, Hillary D, PA-C / 05/16/2025 19:33

Diagnosis from Today's Visit

Diarrhea
Foley catheter problem

What to Do Next

You were treated today on an emergency basis; it may be wise to contact your primary care provider to notify them of your visit today. You may have been referred to your regular doctor or a specialist, please follow up as instructed. If your condition worsens or you can't get in to see the doctor, contact the Emergency Department.

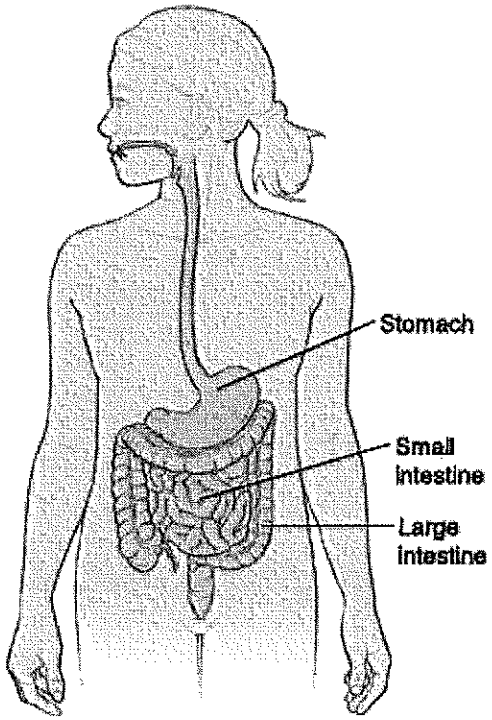
You Need to Schedule the Following Appointments

Follow Up with Lowe, Keri L, NP, MED
When: Within 1 to 2 weeks

Where: Woodway Internal Medicine 4000 W Woodway Dr
Muncie, IN 47305-
(765) 289-5006

Education Materials

Viral Diarrhea (Adult)



Diarrhea caused by a virus is often called viral gastroenteritis. Many people call it the stomach flu, but it has nothing to do with the flu. The virus that causes diarrhea affects the stomach and intestinal tract. It often lasts from 2 to 7 days. Diarrhea is the passing of loose, watery stools 3 or more times a day.

Symptoms

Along with diarrhea, you may have these symptoms:

- Belly (abdominal) pain and cramping
- Nausea and vomiting
- Loss of bowel control
- Fever and chills
- Bloody stools

The danger from repeated diarrhea is dehydration. This is when your body loses too much water and other fluids.

Antibiotics don't work well in treating this illness. But there are things you can do at home that will help.

Home care

Follow these home care tips:

- If symptoms are severe, rest at home for the next 24 hours or until you are feeling better.
- Wash your hands with soap and water or an alcohol-based sanitizer. This helps prevent the spread of infection. Wash your hands after touching anyone who is sick.
- Teach all people in your home when and how to wash their hands. Wet your hands with clean, running water. Lather the backs of your hands, between your fingers, and under your nails. Scrub your hands for at least 20 seconds. If you need a timer, try humming the "Happy Birthday" song from beginning to end twice. Rinse your hands well. Dry them with a clean paper towel.
- Wash your hands after using the toilet and before meals. Clean the toilet after each use.

Food preparation

- People with diarrhea should not make food for others. When making food, wash your hands after touching anyone who is sick.
- Wash your hands after using items that have been in contact with raw food. This includes cutting boards, countertops, and knives.
- Keep uncooked meats away from cooked and ready-to-eat foods.

Medicines

- You may use acetaminophen or nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs (NSAIDS), such as ibuprofen or naproxen, to control fever unless another medicine was prescribed. In addition:
  - Talk with your healthcare provider before using these medicines if you have chronic liver or kidney disease, or ever had a stomach ulcer or GI (gastrointestinal) bleeding.
  - Don't give aspirin (or medicine that contains aspirin) to children or teens unless directed by the provider. Taking aspirin can put them at risk for Reye syndrome. This is a rare but very serious disorder. It most often affects the brain and the liver.
  - Don't use NSAID medicines if you are already taking one for another condition (such as arthritis) or if you are taking aspirin (such as for heart disease or after a stroke).

- Only take antidiarrhea medicines if advised by your healthcare provider. Sometimes they can make your condition worse. If you have bloody diarrhea or fever, check with your provider before taking this type of medicine.

Diet

- Water and clear liquids are important, so you don't get dehydrated. Drink small amounts at a time. Don't guzzle it down. If you are very dehydrated, sports drinks aren't a good choice. They have too much sugar and not enough electrolytes. In this case, commercially available products called oral rehydration solutions are best.
- Caffeine, tobacco, and alcohol can make the diarrhea, cramping, and pain worse. Try to stop using these until you are fully recovered.
- Don't force yourself to eat, especially if you have cramping, vomiting, or diarrhea. Don't eat large amounts at a time, even if you are hungry. It may make you feel worse.
- If you eat, don't have fatty, greasy, spicy, or fried foods.
- Don't have any dairy products, as they can make diarrhea worse.

During the first 24 hours (the first full day) follow the diet below:

- **Drinks.** Water, clear liquids, soft drinks without caffeine; ginger ale, mineral water (plain or flavored), decaffeinated tea and coffee
- **Soups.** Clear broth, consommé, and bouillon
- **Desserts.** Plain gelatin, ice pops, and fruit juice bars

During the next 24 hours (the second day) you may add these to the above if you are feeling better:

- Hot cereal, plain toast, bread, rolls, crackers
- Plain noodles, rice, mashed potatoes, chicken noodle or rice soup

- Unsweetened canned fruit, such as applesauce and bananas (not pineapple and citrus)
- Limit fat intake to less than 15 grams per day. Don't eat margarine, butter, oils, mayonnaise, sauces, gravies, fried foods, peanut butter, meat, poultry, and fish.
- Limit fiber. Don't eat raw or cooked vegetables, fresh fruits (except bananas), and bran cereals.
- Limit caffeine and chocolate. No spices or seasonings except salt.

During the next 24 hours:

- Slowly go back to a normal diet, as you feel better and your symptoms ease.
- If at any time the diarrhea or cramping gets worse, go back to the simpler diet (above) or to clear liquids.

Follow-up care

Follow up with your healthcare provider, or as advised. Call if you aren't getting better in 24 hours or if the diarrhea lasts more than 1 week. This is even more important if you are in a high-risk group, such as:

- Being an older adult
- Having a weak immune system (such as from cancer treatment)
- Having inflammatory bowel disease (Crohn's disease or colitis)

If a stool (diarrhea) sample was taken, you may call in 2 days (or as directed) for the results.

When to get medical advice

Call your healthcare provider right away if any of the following occur:

- More belly pain or constant lower right belly pain
- Lasting vomiting (can't keep liquids down)
- Frequent diarrhea (more than 5 times a day)
- Blood in vomit or stool (black or red color)
- Eating or drinking less
- Dark urine, reduced urine output
- Weakness, dizziness
- Drowsiness
- Fever of 100.4°F (38°C) or higher, or as directed by your provider
- New rash
- Symptoms get worse or you have new symptoms

Call 911

Call 911 if any of the following occur:

- Trouble breathing
- Feeling confused
- Severe drowsiness or trouble waking up
- Fainting or loss of consciousness
- Fast heart rate
- Seizure
- Stiff neck

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Your Medications

	What	How Much	When	Instructions	Next Dose
Unchanged	acetaminophen (acetaminophen 325 mg oral tablet)	2 tab(s) By mouth	Every 4 hours as needed for as needed for pain/fever		
Unchanged	amLODIPine (amLODIPine 5 mg oral tablet)	1 tab(s) By mouth	Once a day		
Unchanged	atorvastatin (atorvastatin 10 mg oral tablet)	1 tab(s) By mouth	At bed time		
Unchanged	bisacodyl (bisacodyl 10 mg rectal suppository)	1 suppository (ies) Per rectum	Once a day as needed for as needed for constipation		
Unchanged	cholecalciferol (Vitamin D3 25 mCg (1,000 intl units) oral tablet)	1 tab(s) By mouth	Once a day		
Unchanged	citalopram	20 Milligram By mouth	Once a day		
Unchanged	docusate-senna (docusate-senna 50 mg-8.6 mg oral tablet)	2 tab(s) By mouth	Two times a day		
Unchanged	ferrous sulfate (FeroSul 325 mg (65 mg elemental iron) oral tablet)	1 tab(s) By mouth	Once a day		
Unchanged	finasteride (finasteride 5 mg oral tablet)	1 tab(s) By mouth	Once a day		
Unchanged	hydrALAZINE (hydrALAZINE 25 mg oral tablet)	1 tab(s) By mouth	Three times a day		
Unchanged	lisinopril (lisinopril 20 mg oral tablet)	1 tab(s) By mouth	Once a day		
Unchanged	lubiprostone (lubiprostone 24 mCg oral capsule)	1 cap By mouth	Two times a day		
Unchanged	magnesium hydroxide (Milk of Magnesia)	2,400 Milligram By mouth	Once a day as needed for as needed for constipation		
Unchanged	Multivitamin with minerals (CertaVite with Antioxidants oral tablet)	1 tab(s) By mouth	Once a day		
Unchanged	omeprazole (omeprazole 40 mg oral delayed release capsule)	1 cap By mouth	Once a day		
Unchanged	polyethylene glycol 3350 (polyethylene glycol 3350 oral powder for reconstitution)	By mouth	Two times a day		
Unchanged	sodium biphosphate-sodium phosphate (Disposable Enema 7 g-19 g rectal enema)	1 Each Per rectum	Once a day as needed for as needed for constipation		

Allergies

NKA

Additional Information

General Information: We are happy to serve you. The examination and treatment you have received have been on an emergency basis only. Call the Emergency Department for any questions or concerns (listed on front page). An emergency is an illness or injury so serious that you need to get care right away to keep from getting worse. If you do not have an emergency, you should go to your doctor's office. For help finding a doctor, visit www.iuhealth.org and search "Find a Doctor". We are very concerned about your general health and safety. Because of this, when driving or riding in a vehicle, we encourage you to always wear your seat belt, and if you have an infant or child, always use the appropriate infant/child car seat. You were treated today on an emergency basis; it may be wise to contact your primary care provider to notify them of your visit today. You may have been referred to your regular doctor or a specialist, please follow up as instructed.

Medication Instructions: If you need a prescription refill, you must see your doctor. Take all medications only as directed. Do not take a medication you are allergic to. If you have been prescribed new medications check with your pharmacist to make sure there are no problems with the medications you are taking.
To help ensure your safety, keep a copy of this discharge instruction to share with your health care provider at your next visit. It contains a copy of your medication list, diagnoses made in our emergency department and information about treatment you received here.

Referral Instructions: You were treated today on an emergency basis; it may be wise to contact you primary care provider to notify them of your visit today. You may have been referred to your regular doctor or a specialist, please follow up as instructed. If your condition worsens or you can't get in to see the doctor, contact the Emergency Department.

Insurance Information: When you sign in, it is your responsibility to give correct and complete billing information. This is important in case there is a need to contact you with test results. Federal law requires us to provide you a medical screening exam and stabilizing treatment for any emergent medical condition found regardless of your insurance or ability to pay. Your insurance company may require pre-authorization or notification of your visit, both of which are your responsibility. We will make every effort to properly bill your insurance company on your behalf. If you need financial assistance, please call the number listed on front page.

Diagnostic Studies: If you had a diagnostic study performed, we will notify you of any lab, EKG or X-ray findings that would require a change in treatment. A specialist reviews most diagnostic studies after your visit. Some test results are not available for 24-72 hours.

If you have been given medications or a prescription in the Emergency Department: Many medications can make you feel sleepy, impair your ability to drive, or effect your ability to make good decisions. Some of these medicines can even make you stop breathing when you go to sleep, particularly if several different medicines are combined. For this reason, we ask that you arrange for someone else to give you a ride home, do not operate machinery or make important decisions, and do not take any sleeping pills, pain pills, or drink alcohol for at least 4-6 hours from the time you leave the emergency department. It is also important to know that the use of narcotic medications can be habit forming.

Crisis Hotlines:
USA National Suicide Hotline (Toll free and 24/7): Dial 988

Antibiotics Are Not Always the Answer: Antibiotics only treat bacterial infections; they are not needed for viral illnesses. When an antibiotic is not prescribed, ask your healthcare professional for tips on how to relieve symptoms and feel better. For more information on when antibiotics may be helpful, visit www.cdc.gov/getsmart.

Quit Smoking for Health: Smoking has been proven to be hazardous to your health. If you would like to quit smoking, call 1-800-QUIT-NOW (1-800-784-8669) for free counseling and two weeks of free Nicotine Replacement Therapy. Helpful information can also be found online at www.iuhealth.org or the Quitline can also provide information about the closest smoking cessation program to you.

My IU Health: My IU Health allows convenient, electronic access to manage your health. Sign up for a secure account at www.myiuhealth.org.